UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Regional • 2011



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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Region • 2011

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The term that indicates the degree to which a work creates the appearance of truth is

   A) liminality.
   B) poetic license.
   C) realism.
   D) verisimilitude.
   E) virelay.

2. The influential Irish poet and Celtic Renaissance figure who is known for his mythopoeia-driven plays and poetry and who received the 1923 Nobel Prize for Literature is

   A) T. S. Eliot.
   B) Seamus Heaney.
   C) James Joyce.
   D) George Bernard Shaw.
   E) William Butler Yeats.

3. A term applied to the silent acting that appears in Elizabethan drama and that often serves to foreshadow events is

   A) burlesque.
   B) dumb show.
   C) masque.
   D) mystery play.
   E) pantomime.

4. The concept, introduced into literature by James Joyce, representing an intuitive grasp of reality achieved in a quick flash of recognition, is known as a(n)

   A) alienation effect.
   B) avant-garde.
   C) epiphany.
   D) orphism.
   E) recalcitrance.

5. The Jewish American author known for his campus novel *A New Life* and recipient of the 1967 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for his novel *The Fixer* is

   A) Saul Bellow.
   B) Allen Ginsberg.
   C) Norman Mailer.
   D) Bernard Malamud.
   E) Arthur Miller.

6. A term that denotes the gruesome combination of farce and tragedy in both subject and style is

   A) arabesque.
   B) gothic.
   C) macabre.
   D) *Märchen*.
   E) vulgar.

7. A term used metaphorically as a critical standard to detect "the presence or absence of high poetic quality" through a comparison with the "lines and expressions of the great masters" is

   A) chrestomathy.
   B) emblem book.
   C) purple patch.
   D) rubric.
   E) touchstone.

8. A poem with a certain number of syllables per line and the same number of lines in a stanza is known as a

   A) lipogram.
   B) macaronic verse.
   C) pruning poem.
   D) square poem.
   E) treatise poem.

9. The nineteenth-century literary movement that rests on the credo "art for art's sake" and is intimately associated with Oscar Wilde and Walter Pater, among others, is

   A) aestheticism.
   B) cubism.
   C) minimalism.
   D) surrealism.
   E) vorticism.

10. Not one of the traditional Greek muses known for being called upon for inspiration by practitioners in both the arts and sciences is

    A) Calliope.
    B) Erato.
    C) Terpsichore.
    D) Urania.
    E) Zooey.

11. The American authors Mary Eleanor Wilkins Freeman, Charlotte Perkins Gilman, Willa Cather, Amy Lowell, and Edith Wharton all read newspaper headlines announcing both the beginning and the end of the

A) American Civil War.
B) American Revolutionary War.
C) First World War.
D) Second World War.
E) Vietnam War.

12. A word or name fabricated by spelling another word or words backward, as when Daniel Suarez, in 2006, published his novel *Daemon* under the authorship of Leinad Zeraus, is called a(n)

A) allonym.
B) ananym.
C) eponym.
D) heteronym.
E) pseudonym.

13. The literary age in British literary history, represented by George Orwell, Samuel Beckett, Joyce Cary, and Graham Greene, among others, that is characterized by the post-WWII struggle to re-establish a sense of nation and tradition, is the

A) Age of the Romantic Movement in England.
B) Diminishing Age in English Literature.
C) Naturalistic and Symbolistic Period.
D) Postmodernist Period.
E) Realistic Period.

14. The term for a feat of strength and virtuosity, a feat that is an outstanding demonstration of skill, is

A) divine afflatus.
B) double elephant.
C) gigantism.
D) *magnum opus*.
E) *tour de force*.

15. Associated with the Jazz Age, the author of *Tender Is the Night*, *The Beautiful and the Damned*, *The Great Gatsby*, and *The Last Tycoon*, and the short story collection *Flappers and Philosophers*, is

A) Charles W. Chesnutt.
B) Stephen Crane.
C) Theodore Dreiser.
D) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
E) Ernest Hemingway.

16. The genre of literary expression, dominant in late-nineteenth-century America, that exploits the speech, dress, mannerisms, habits of thought, and topography peculiar to a certain region is known as

A) dialectic.
B) frontier literature.
C) local color writing.
D) naturalism.
E) realism.

17. Described as an author of women's identity crises, the recipient of both the 1989 Pulitzer Prize for Drama and the 1989 Tony Award for *The Heidi Chronicles* is

A) Beth Henley.
B) Marsha Norman.
C) Suzan-Lori Parks.
D) Paula Vogel.
E) Wendy Wasserstein.

18. Responsible for both translating and having translated important Latin works, including Pope Gregory's *Pastoral Care*, Boethius's *Consolation of Philosophy*, Bede's *Ecclesiastical History of the English People* is

A) Alfred.
B) Arthur.
C) Canute.
D) Chaucer.
E) Edwin.

19. Not one of the poetic terms introduced by British poet Gerard Manley Hopkins is

A) bob and wheel.
B) inscape.
C) instress.
D) outride.
E) sprung rhythm.

20. Known also as the heroic line because it is often used in English-language epic or heroic poetry, including English translations of the classical epics, is the

A) dactylic hexameter line.
B) dactylic pentameter line.
C) dactylic tetrameter line.
D) iambic pentameter line.
E) iambic tetrameter line.

21. The genre that encompasses novels, usually comic in nature, that have universities as their setting is the

A) *Bildungsroman*.
B) campus novel.
C) education novel.
D) novel of manners.
E) scholium.

22. The African American poet, author of "We Real Cool" and recipient of the 1950 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for her collection *Annie Allen*, is

A) Gwendolyn Brooks.
B) Rita Dove.
C) Mona Van Duyn.
D) Claudia Emerson.
E) Mary Oliver.

23. The group of eighteenth-century poets, represented in England and America, respectively, by Thomas Gray and William Cullen Bryant, known for writing long poems about death and immortality is the

A) Black Mountain School.
B) Cavalier Poets.
C) Graveyard School.
D) Pre-Raphaelites.
E) Tribe of Ben.

24. The character from Thomas Morton's play *Speed the Plough* of whose judgments everyone is very much afraid and who thus serves as an upholder of social conventions is

A) Mr. Bowlder.
B) Mrs. Grundy.
C) Mrs. Malaprop.
D) Mr. Pooter.
E) Dr. Spooner.

25. The term used to describe the effect produced when an emotion or an experience, whether autobiographical or not, is so objectified that it can be understood as being independent of the immediate experience of its maker is

A) aesthetic distance.
B) affective fallacy.
C) bathos.
D) empathy.
E) pathetic fallacy.

26. Not considered a vatic poet, a poet regarded as divinely inspired, prophetic, or oracular, is

A) William Blake.
B) E. E. Cummings.
C) Allen Ginsberg.
D) Percy Bysshe Shelley.
E) Walt Whitman.

27. The use of a word peculiar to a given language: an expression that cannot be translated literally is called a(n)

A) catchword.
B) cliché.
C) idiom.
D) jargon.
E) regionalism.

28. The British author whose popularity soared during the early twentieth century, the author of *The Jungle Book*, *Captains Courageous*, and *Just So Stories for Little Children*, is

A) Charles Dickens.
B) Robert Graves.
C) Thomas Hardy.
D) Rudyard Kipling.
E) C. S. Lewis.

29. A word so often repeated that it is identified with a person or with an object, such as Homer Simpson's "D'oh" and Charles Montgomery Burns's "Excellent," is a(n)

A) catchword.
B) cliché.
C) idiom.
D) jargon.
E) regionalism.

30. The derogatory title applied by *Blackwood's Magazine* to a group of nineteenth-century British writers including Hazlitt, Hunt, and Keats because of their alleged poor taste in such concerns as diction and rhyme is

A) Cockney School.
B) Fleshy School of Poetry.
C) Martian School.
D) Satanic School.
E) Spasmodic School.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Eugene O'Neill's *The Hairy Ape*.
Items 37-43 are associated with Jane Austen's *Pride and Prejudice*.
Items 44-50 are associated with Theodore Roethke's poetry (selected).

31. The stage directions for Scene Two of O'Neill's *The Hairy Ape* read, she "is the expression not of its life energy but merely of the artificiality that energy had won for itself in the spending"; she is
    A) the lady who announces, "Monkey fur!"
    B) Mildred.
    C) Mildred's aunt.
    D) the ocean.
    E) the ship.

32. Yank's declaration, "I'm de end! I'm de start! I start somep'n and de woild moves! It—dat's me!—de new dat's moiderin' the old!" is in response to
    A) the challenge from the union officer.
    B) the gorilla's growling proudly.
    C) Mildred's low, choking cry.
    D) Paddy's admitting sailing ships are part of the past.
    E) the second engineer's showing up with Mildred.

33. In the firemen's forecastle, Yank shouts, "De nutty Harp is sayin' somep'n." Yank's use of the word *Harp* to designate one of his mates is an example of
    A) abridgment.
    B) barbarism.
    C) gallows humor.
    D) metonymy.
    E) pun.

34. Yank's exclamation, "Dey're just baggage," is a denigration of
    A) "dat Salvation Army" with its "socialist bull."
    B) "dem slobs in de foist cabin."
    C) "the bleedin' parasites" exiting church.
    D) "the Elks" and "the Black Hand."
    E) "the tough nuts dat de gang called gorillas."

35. Yank, noting the bars and the locks, attributes the responsibility for the material existence of the cell in which he is being held to
    A) the furriers of Fifth Avenue.
    B) the I.W.W. officers.
    C) the lead zookeeper.
    D) Mildred's aunt.
    E) the president of the Steele Trust.

36. Yank's calling-out, his "Come down outa dere, yuh yellow, brassbuttoned, Belfast bum, yuh! [. . .] Yuh lousy, stinkin', yellow mut of a Catholic-moiderin' bastard!" is directed at
    A) the engineer.
    B) the gorilla.
    C) the I.W.W. secretary.
    D) Long.
    E) the policeman.

37. In Jane Austen's *Pride and Prejudice*, Mr. Gardiner's letter reveals that Mr. Wickham has resolved to move from
    A) bachelorhood to the clergy.
    B) Brighton to Gretna Green.
    C) London to Pemberley.
    D) Meryton to Netherfield.
    E) the militia to the regulars.

38. "Elizabeth could not but smile" at her mother's threat, "Your mother will never see you again if you do *not* marry
    A) Mr. Bingley."
    B) Mr. Collins."
    C) Mr. Darcy."
    D) Colonel Fitzwilliam."
    E) Mr. Wickham."

39. The emphasis on dancing, "one of the first refinements of polished societies," reflects the
    A) competitiveness among siblings.
    B) demise of card playing.
    C) importance of courtship.
    D) importance of music.
    E) size of the manor houses.

40. The novel's title, as well as by the several juxtaposings of characters and situations in the story, create a tone that is
    A) didactic.
    B) intimate.
    C) ironic.
    D) objective.
    E) satiric.

41. Mr. Bennet's comment following his reading of Mr. Collins's letter, "*his* perfect indifference, and *your* pointed dislike, make it so delightfully absurd!" refers directly to

A) Charles and Jane.
B) Darcy and Anne.
C) Darcy and Caroline.
D) Darcy and Elizabeth.
E) George and Lydia.

42. Elizabeth is a bit confused when she is told "Our habits of expence make us too dependant, and there are not many in my rank of life who can afford to marry without some attention to money" by

A) Mr. Bennett.
B) Lady de Bourgh.
C) Mr. Collins.
D) Mr. Darcy.
E) Colonel Fitzwilliam.

43. Never "so bewitched by any woman as he was by her," Darcy "really believed, that were it not for the inferiority of her connections, he should be in some danger"; the danger to which he refers is

A) affronting Mrs. Bennet.
B) failing Georgiana.
C) falling for Elizabeth.
D) marrying Anne.
E) marrying Caroline.

Items 44-46 refer to Theodore Roethke's

Elegy

Her face like a rain-beaten stone on the day she rolled off
With the dark hearse, and enough flowers for an alderman,—
And so she was, in her way. Aunt Tilly.

Sighs, sighs, who says they have sequence?
Between the spirit and the flesh,—what war?
She never knew;
For she asked no quarter, and gave none,
Who sat with the dead when the relatives left,
Who fed and tended the infirm, the mad, the epileptic,
And, with a harsh rasp of a laugh at herself,
Faced up to the worst.

I recall how she harried the children away all the late summer
From the one beautiful thing in her yard, the peach-tree;
How she kept the wizened, the fallen, the misshapen for herself,
And picked and pickled the best, to be left on rickety doorsteps.

And yet she died in agony,
Her tongue, at the last, thick, black as an ox's.

Terror of cops, bill collectors, betrayers of the poor,—
I see you in some celestial supermarket,
Moving serenely among the leeks and cabbages,
Probing the squash,
Bearing down, with two steady eyes,
On the quaking butcher.

44. In Roethke's poem "Elegy," the persona's estimation of Aunt Tilley's relationship with the frequently neglected among us is reinforced in his observation regarding the

A) butcher.
B) children.
C) dead.
D) peaches.
E) worst.

45. Suggestive of the nature of Aunt Tilley's illness, lines 10-11, "And, with a harsh rasp of a laugh at herself, / faced up to the worst," are

A) apathetic.
B) bitter.
C) ironic.
D) nostalgic.
E) optimistic.

46. The persona's observation "enough flowers for an alderman" (line 2) is significant because it suggests that

A) florists, if not the butcher, loved her.
B) hearses convey too much sadness.
C) she liked plants as much as Roethke.
D) she was involved in local government.
E) she was well regarded by the community.

Items 47-50 refer to Theodore Roethke's

A Walk in Late Summer

1.

A gull rides on the ripples of a dream,
White upon white, slow-settling on a stone;
Across my lawn the soft-backed creatures come,
In the weak light they wander, each alone.
Bring me the meek, for I would know their ways;
I am a connoisseur of midnight eyes.
The small! The small! I hear them singing clear
On the long banks, in the soft summer air.

2.

What is there for the soul to understand?
The slack face of the dismal pure inane?
The wind dies down; my will dies with the wind,
God's in that stone, or I am not a man!
Body and soul transcend appearances
Before the caving-in of all that is;
I'm dying piecemeal, fervent in decay;
My moments linger—that's eternity.

3.

A late rose ravages the casual eye,
A blaze of being on a central stem.
It lies upon us to undo the lie
Of living merely in the realm of time.
Existence moves toward a certain end—
A thing all earthly lovers understand.
That dove's elaborate way of coming near
Reminds me I am dying with the year.

4.

A tree arises on a central plain—
It is no trick of change or chance of light.
A tree all out of shape from wind and rain,
A tree thinned by the wind obscures my sight.
The long day dies; I walked the woods alone;
Beyond the ridge two wood thrush sing as one.
Being delights in being, and in time.
The evening wraps me, steady as a flame.

47. The rhyme scheme of Roethke's "A Walk in Late Summer" relies on

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) dissonance.
D) eye rhyme.
E) homeoteleuton.

48. The nature and purpose of the persona's journey—his walk into a late summer's evening—is best illuminated in

A) lines 4-5.
B) lines 9-12.
C) lines 19-22.
D) lines 23-24.
E) lines 29-31.

49. Line 12, especially, which remarks on the divinity in the animate world, points, arguably, to his

A) animism.
B) deism.
C) paganism.
D) pantheism.
E) transcendentalism.

50. The tone of "A Walk in Late Summer" is

A) censorious.
B) didactic.
C) irreverent.
D) philosophical.
E) whimsical.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-55 refer to Christina Rossetti's

Cobwebs

It is a land with neither night nor day,
Nor heat nor cold, nor any wind, nor rain,
Nor hills nor valleys; but one even plain
Stretches thro' long unbroken miles away:
While thro' the sluggish air a twilight grey
Broodeth; no moons or seasons wax and wane,
No ebb and flow are there among the main,
No bud-time no leaf-falling there for aye,
No ripple on the sea, no shifting sand,
No beat of wings to stir the stagnant space:
No pulse of life through all the loveless land
And loveless sea: no trace of days before,
No guarded home, no time-worn resting-place
No future hope no fear forevermore.

51. The repetition that characterizes the beginning of lines 7-11 of Rossetti's "Cobwebs," as well as the final two lines of the poem, is known as

A) alliteration.
B) anaphora.
C) assonance.
D) ploce.
E) polyptoton.

Item 56 refers to Sebastian Dangerfield's

autochthonous [1]

indigenous folk
watch stunned unable to act
as the earth they love
falls prey to apparatchiks [2]
who defile a shared birthright

[1] aboriginal
[2] functionaries

52. The form of Rossetti's poem is a variant of the

A) caudate sonnet.
B) English sonnet.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) Miltonic sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

53. The unusual or unnecessary repetition of the same conjunction, which characterizes lines 1-3 of "Cobwebs," is known as

A) asyndeton.
B) chiasmus.
C) epanalepsis.
D) metalepsis.
E) polysyndeton.

54. If optimism is to be found in Rossetti's sonnet it is in

A) line 2.
B) line 6.
C) line 8.
D) line 13.
E) line 14.

55. The picturesque metaphorical compounds " bud-time" and "leaf-falling" (line 8) are fine examples of modern

A) epitaphs.
B) idioms.
C) kennings.
D) transferred epithets.
E) voltas.

56. The form of Dangerfield's poem is

A) haiku.
B) kabuki.
C) katauta.
D) senyru.
E) tanka.

Items 57-60 refer to Robert Herrick's

To Daffodils

Fair daffodils, we weep to see
You haste away so soon;
As yet the early-rising sun
Has not attain'd his noon.
Stay, stay,
Until the hasting day
Has run
But to the evensong;
And, having pray'd together, we
Will go with you along.

We have short time to stay, as you;
We have as short a spring;
As quick a growth to meet decay,
As you, or anything.
We die,
As your hours do, and dry
Away,
Like to the summer's rain;
Or as the pearls of morning's dew,
Ne'er to be found again.

57. The persona's addressing the fair daffodils in Robert Herrick's "To Daffodils" is a good example of

A) anthropomorphism.
B) apostrophe.
C) personification.
D) prosopopoeia.
E) rhetorical accent.

58. The motif that best represents the poem's theme is

A) *carpe diem*.
B) *la femme inspiratrice*.
C) *memento mori*.
D) *ubi sunt*.
E) *utile et dulce*.

59. Herrick's comparing of the brevity of human life to a flower's lifespan is a(n)

A) analogy.
B) catechresis.
C) contrast.
D) hyperbole.
E) parallelism.

60. A reinforcing of the poem's principle comparison occurs in the second stanza in the form of two

A) allelographs.
B) diminishing metaphors.
C) false etymologies.
D) flytings.
E) similes.

Items 61-65 refer to John Frederick Nims's

Love Poem

My clumsiest dear, whose hands shipwreck vases,
At whose quick touch all glasses chip and ring,
Whose palms are bulls in china, burs in linen,
And have no cunning with any soft thing 4

Except all ill-at-ease fidgeting people:
The refugee uncertain at the door
You make at home; deftly you steady
The drunk clambering on his undulant floor. 8

Unpredictable dear, the taxi drivers' terror,
Shrinking from far headlights pale as a dime
Yet leaping before apoplectic streetcars—
Misfit in any space. And never on time. 12

A wrench in clocks and the solar system. Only
With words and people and love you move at ease;
In traffic of wit expertly maneuver
And keep us, all devotion, at your knees. 16

Forgetting your coffee spreading on our flannel,
Your lipstick grinning on our coat,
So gaily in love's unbreakable heaven
Our souls on glory of spilt bourbon float. 20

Be with me, darling, early and late. Smash glasses—
I will study wry music for your sake.
For should your hands drop white and empty
All the toys of the world would break. 24

61. In line 13 of Nims's poem, the stacking and compressing of the implied metaphor, the syllepsis, and the hyperbole that contribute to "A wrench in clocks and the solar system" together comprise an instance of

A) metafiction.
B) metalepsis.
C) metaphor.
D) metaphysical conceit.
E) metonymy.

62. The poem's tone, beginning with the first line and concluding with the final stanza's invocation is

A) amusedly complimentary.
B) condescendingly loving.
C) insultingly critical.
D) irreverently passive.
E) lightheartedly hurtful.

63. The imagery of "apoplectic streetcars" (line 11) and, perhaps, "lipstick grinning" is strengthened by

A) apostrophe.
B) hyperbole.
C) metonymy.
D) personification.
E) reification.

64. The theme of Nims's "Love Poem" is

A) delight in the shortcomings of one's lover.
B) music can make life better.
C) triumph over impatience.
D) women drivers have difficulty with many things.
E) writing poetry is good couples therapy.

65. The combination of sense and grammatical construction of line 4 to line 5 of the poem's next stanza is an example of

A) enjambment.
B) fused rhyme.
C) run-on line.
D) tag-line.
E) truncation.

The required Tie-Breaking Essay prompt is found on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three pages of blank paper have been provided for this essay; however, it is not expected that the essay will be longer than 150 words; however, the essay should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than a few sentences.

Read Edna St. Vincent Millay's "An Ancient Gesture" and offer a discussion regarding what the poem has to say about the universality of being human, specifically, the universality of being a woman married, and about dealing with troubles.

An Ancient Gesture

I thought, as I wiped my eyes on the corner of my apron:
Penelope did this too.
And more than once: you can't keep weaving all day
And undoing it all through the night;
Your arms get tired, and the back of your neck gets tight;
And along towards morning, when you think it will never be light,
And your husband has been gone, and you don't know where, for years.
Suddenly you burst into tears;
There is simply nothing else to do.

And I thought, as I wiped my eyes on the corner of my apron:
This is an ancient gesture, authentic, antique,
In the very best tradition, classic, Greek;
Ulysses did this too.
But only as a gesture,—a gesture which implied
To the assembled throng that he was much too moved to speak.
He learned it from Penelope . . .
Penelope, who really cried.

1954

2nd _____ _____

1st _____ _____
score initials

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest

ANSWER SHEET

Contestant # _____ Conference # _____

Please write answers as CAPITAL letters.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. _____	11. _____	21. _____
2. _____	12. _____	22. _____
3. _____	13. _____	23. _____
4. _____	14. _____	24. _____
5. _____	15. _____	25. _____
6. _____	16. _____	26. _____
7. _____	17. _____	27. _____
8. _____	18. _____	28. _____
9. _____	19. _____	29. _____
10. _____	20. _____	30. _____

number correct _____ x 1 pt each = _____

Part 2: UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

31. _____	38. _____	45. _____
32. _____	39. _____	46. _____
33. _____	40. _____	47. _____
34. _____	41. _____	48. _____
35. _____	42. _____	49. _____
36. _____	43. _____	50. _____
37. _____	44. _____	

number correct _____ x 2 pts each = _____

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism **15 items (2 points each)**

51. _____	56. _____	61. _____
52. _____	57. _____	62. _____
53. _____	58. _____	63. _____
54. _____	59. _____	64. _____
55. _____	60. _____	65. _____

number correct _____ x 2 pts each = _____

total points

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KEY

Page numbers are those associated with the *Handbook* 10e, the Penguin 1996 edition of *P&P*, and the Vintage edition of *The Hairy Ape*.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1.	D	572	11.	C	633	21.	B	84
2.	E	657	12.	B	26	22.	A	662
3.	B	182	13.	B	166	23.	C	255
4.	C	204	14.	E	553	24.	B	258
5.	D	661	15.	D	635	25.	A	7
6.	C	326	16.	C	319	26.	B	
7.	E	553	17.	E	665	27.	C	283
8.	D	524	18.	A	383	28.	D	629
9.	A	7	19.	A	71	29.	A	88
10.	E	356	20.	D	267	30.	A	108

Part 2: UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

31.	B	154	38.	B	110	45.	C	
32.	D		39.	C	(26)	46.	E	
33.	D	152 (344)	40.	C		47.	B	123
34.	B	147	41.	D	344	48.	C	
35.	E	186	42.	E	179	49.	D	395
36.	A	161	43.	C	51	50.	D	
37.	E	296	44.	D				

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism **15 items (2 points each)**

51.	B	26	56.	E	545	61.	B	340
52.	C	300	57.	B	40	62.	A	
53.	E	428	58.	A	87	63.	D	412
54.	E		59.	A	25	64.	A	
55.	C	306	60.	E	514	65.	A	199

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Edna St. Vincent Millay's "An Ancient Gesture"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of these poems include

allusion,
diction,
free verse,
imagery,
literal meaning,
metaphor,
symbolic meaning,
theme,
tradition, and
tone.

The competitor should recognize Millay's allusion to Penelope's lengthy, patient wait and Ulysses' being welcomed, once recognized, by his people. The young scholar is being asked to discuss the poem in terms of the universality of being human and the universality of being a woman married, both in terms of dealing with unspecified troubles.

Millay's modern Penelope, the poem's persona, is rather frank about the emotional weight of enduring whatever it is that she endures. The implication seems to be that little recognition comes to the woman of the household. Millay's persona, through allusion, recognizes in her own plight the plight of women historically, and she seems to find solace in the tradition of enduring—whatever it is that women have variously had to endure. She finds specific solace in the tradition of a woman's quietly suffering in the background. The strength of Millay's statement, indeed, the crux, is both that the woman's response is genuine and the man emulates, learns from, the woman. Candor, which might not be so ancient, is all.